

Book definitions:

Chapter 1: (Book Page 3-16)

Communication perspectives

Page 3:

Communication: The process of creating or sharing meaning in informal conversation, group interaction, or public speaking.

Participants: Individuals who assume the roles of senders and receivers during an interaction.

Messages: Verbal utterances, visual images, and nonverbal behaviors to which meaning is attributed during communication.

Meanings: Thoughts in our minds and interpretations of others' messages.

Symbols: Words, sounds, and actions that are generally understood to represent ideas and feelings.

Encoding: The process of putting our thoughts and feelings into words and nonverbal cues.

Decoding: The process of interpreting another's message.

Page 4:

Context: The setting in which communication occurs, including what precedes and follows what is said.

Physical context: A communication encounter's location, environmental conditions (temperature, lighting, noise level), distance between communicators, seating arrangements, and time of day.

Social context: The nature of the relationship that exists between the participants.

Historical context: The background provided by previous communication episodes between the participants that influence understandings in the current encounter

Page 5:

Psychological context: The mood and feelings each person brings to a conversation.

Cultural context: The values, attitudes, beliefs, orientations, and underlying assumptions prevalent among people in a society.

Channel: Both the route traveled by the message and the means of transportation.

Interference (noise): Any stimulus that interferes with the process of sharing meaning.

Physical interference: Sights, sounds, and other stimuli in the environment that draw people's attention away from intended meaning.

Page 6:

Psychological interference: Internal distractions based on thoughts, feelings, or emotional reactions to symbols.

Internal noise: Thoughts and feelings that compete for attention and interfere with the communication process.

Page 7:

Semantic noise: Distractions aroused by certain symbols that take our attention away from the main message.

Feedback: Reactions and responses to messages.

Page 8:

Communication setting: The different communication environments within which people interact, characterized by the number of participants and the extent to which the interaction is formal or informal; also called communication contexts.

Intrapersonal communication: The interactions that occur in a person's mind when he or she is talking with himself or herself.

Page 9:

Interpersonal communication: Informal interaction between two people who have an identifiable relationship with each other.

Small group communication: Two to 20 people who participants come together for the specific purpose of solving a problem or arriving at a decision.

Public communication: one participant, the speaker, delivers a prepared message to a group or audience who has assembled to hear the speaker.

Page 11:

Spontaneous expressions: Messages spoken without much conscious thought.

Scripted messages: Phrasings learned from past encounters that we judge to be appropriate to the present situation.

Constructed messages: Messages put together with careful thought when we recognize that our known scripts are inadequate for the situation.

Immediacy: The degree of liking or attractiveness in a relationship.

Control: The degree to which one participant is perceived to be more dominant or powerful.

Page 12:

Culture: Systems of knowledge shared by a relatively large group of people.

Page 14:

Ethics: A set of moral principles that may be held by a society, a group, or an individual.

Ethical dilemma: A choice involving two unsatisfactory alternatives.

Page 15:

Communication competence: The impression that communicative behavior is both appropriate and effective in a given situation.

Page 16:

Credibility: A perception of a speaker's knowledge, trustworthiness, and warmth.

Social ease: Communicating without appearing to be anxious or nervous.

Communication apprehension: Fear or anxiety associated with real or anticipated communication with others.

Chapter 2:

Perception of self and others (Book page 24-41)

Page 24:

Perception: The process of selectively attending to information and assigning meaning to it.

Page 25:

Pattern: A set of characteristics used to differentiate some things from others.

Page 26:

Interpret: Assigning meaning to information.

Self-concept: Your self-identity.

Self-esteem: Your overall evaluation of your competence and personal worthiness. What is a self - concept and how is it formed and maintained?

Page 31:

Incongruence: The gap between our inaccurate self-perceptions and reality.

Page 32:

Self-fulfilling prophecy: A false perception of a situation or characteristic or skill that leads to behaviors that perpetuate that false perception as true.

Page 36:

Self-monitoring: The internal process of observing, analyzing, and regulating your own behavior based on your analysis of the situation and others' responses to you.

Role: A pattern of learned behaviors that people use to meet the perceived demands of a particular context.

Page 37:

Uncertainty reduction: the process of monitoring the social environment to learn more about self and others.

Page 38:

Implicit personality theories: Assumptions about which physical characteristics and personality traits or behaviors are associated with one another.

Halo effect: To generalize and perceive that a person has a whole set of characteristics when you have actually observed only one characteristic, trait, or behavior.

Stereotypes: generalizations, usually exaggerated or oversimplified and often offensive, use to describe or distinguish a group.

Page 39:

Prejudice: A rigid attitude that is based on group membership and predisposes an individual to feel, think, or act in a negative way toward another person or group.

Discrimination: A negative action toward a social group or its members on account of group membership.

Page 40:

Attributions: Reasons we give for others' behavior.

Page 41:

Perception check: a message that reflects your understanding of the meaning of another person's nonverbal behavior.

Chapter 3:

Communicating verbally (Book page 48-59)

Page 48:

Language: A body of symbols (most commonly words) and the systems for their use in messages that are common to the people of the same speech community.

Speech community: A group of people who speak the same language (also called a language community).

Words symbols: Used by a speech community to represent objects, ideas, and feelings.

Sapir-Whorf hypothesis: A theory claiming that language influences perception. Language allows us to perceive certain aspects of the world by naming them and allows us to ignore other parts of the world by not naming them.

Page 50:

Denotation: The direct, explicit meaning a speech community formally gives a word.

Connotation: The feelings or evaluations we associate with a word.

Syntactic context: The position of a word in a sentence and the other words around it.

Page 51:

Low-context cultures: Cultures in which messages are direct, specific, and detailed.

High-context cultures: Cultures in which messages are indirect, general, and ambiguous.

Page 52:

Feminine styles of language: Use words of empathy and support, emphasize concrete and personal language, and show politeness and tentativeness in speaking.

Masculine styles of language: Use words of status and problem solving, emphasize abstract and general language, and show assertiveness and control in speaking.

Page 53:

Specific words: Words that clarify meaning by narrowing what is understood from a general category to a particular item or group within that category.

Concrete words: Words that appeal to the senses and help us see, hear, smell, taste, or touch.

Precise words: Words that narrow a larger category to a smaller group within that category.

Page 54:

Dating information: Specifying the time or time period that a fact was true or known to be true.

Indexing generalizations: The mental and verbal practice of acknowledging the presence of individual differences when voicing generalizations.

Page 55:

Vivid wording: Wording that is full of life, vigorous, bright, and intense. simile a direct comparison of dissimilar things.

Metaphor: A comparison that establishes a figurative identity between objects being compared.

Page 56:

Emphasis: The importance given to certain words or ideas.

Page 58:

Jargon: Technical terms whose meanings are understood only by select groups.

Linguistic sensitivity: Language choices that demonstrate respect for listener(s).

Page 59:

Slang: Informal vocabulary used by particular groups in society.

Generic language: Using words that may apply only to one sex, race, or other group as though they represent everyone.

Chapter 4:

Communicating verbally (Book page 67-76)

Page 67:

Nonverbal communication: Behaviors bodily actions and vocal qualities that typically accompany a verbal message.

Emoticons: Typed symbols that convey emotional aspects of an online message.

Page 68:

Kinesics: The interpretation of how body motions communicate.

Gestures: Movements of our hands, arms, and fingers that we use to describe or to emphasize.

Illustrators: Gestures that augment a verbal message.

Emblems: Gestures can substitute for words.

Page 69:

Adaptors: Gestures that respond to a physical need.

Eye contact or gaze: How and how much we look at people with whom we are communicating.

Oculesics: How and how much we look at others when communicating.

Page 70:

Facial expression: The arrangement of facial muscles to communicate emotional states or reactions to messages.

Posture: The position and movement of the body.

Body orientation: Posture in relation to another person.

Page 71:

Body movement: Movement that helps clarify meaning (motivated) or movement that distracts listeners from the point being made (unmotivated).

Haptics: What and how touch communicates.

Vocalic: The interpretation of the message based on the paralinguistic features.

Paralanguage: The voiced but not verbal part of a spoken message.

Page 72:

Pitch: The highness or lowness of vocal tone.

Volume: The loudness or softness of tone.

Rate: The speed at which a person speaks.

Quality: The sound of a person's voice that distinguishes it from others.

Intonation: The variety, melody, or inflection in one's voice.

Page 73:

Vocalized pauses: Extraneous sounds or words that interrupt fluent speech.

Proxemics: The interpretation of a person's use of space and distance.

Personal space: The distance you try to maintain when you interact with other people.

Page 74:

Physical space: The physical environment over which you exert control.

Artifacts: Objects and possessions we use to decorate the physical space we control.

Page 75:

Chronemics: The interpretation of a person's use of time.

Monochronic time orientation: A time orientation that emphasizes doing one thing at a time.

Polychronic time: Orientation a time orientation that emphasizes doing multiple things at once.

Page 76:

Endomorph: Round and heavy body type.

Mesomorph: Muscular and athletic body type.

Ectomorph: Lean and little muscle development.

Chapter 6:

Communicating across cultures (Book page 112-130)

Page 112:

Culture: The values, attitudes, beliefs, orientations, and underlying assumptions prevalent among people in a society.

Culture shock: The psychological discomfort you may feel when you attempt to adjust to a new cultural situation.

Page 113:

Intercultural communication: Interactions that occur between people whose cultural assumptions are so different that the communication between them is altered.

Dominant culture: The attitudes, values, beliefs, and customs that the majority of people in a society hold in common.

Page 114:

Co-cultures: groups of people living within a dominant culture but exhibiting communication that is sufficiently different to distinguish them from the dominant culture.

Ethnicity: A classification of people based on combinations of shared characteristics such as nationality, geographic origin, language, religion, ancestral customs, and tradition.

Page 115:

Religion: A system of beliefs shared by a group and that supplies the group with an entity(ies) for devotion, rituals for worship, and a code of ethics.

Social class: An indicator of a person's position in a social hierarchy, as determined by income, education, occupation, and social habits.

Page 117:

Individualistic culture: Emphasizes personal rights and responsibilities, privacy, voicing one's opinion, freedom, innovation, and self-expression.

Page 118:

Collectivist culture: emphasizes community, collaboration, shared interest, harmony, the public good, and avoiding embarrassment.

Page 121:

Low uncertainty-avoidance cultures: Cultures characterized by greater acceptance of, and less need to control, unpredictable people, relationships, or events.

High uncertainty-avoidance cultures: Cultures characterized by a low tolerance for, and a high need to control, unpredictable people, relationships, or events.

High power-distance: The cultural belief that inequalities in power, status, and rank are "natural" and that these differences should be acknowledged and accentuated.

Page 122:

Low-power distance: The cultural belief that inequalities in power, status, and rank should be underplayed and muted.

Masculine culture: A culture in which people are expected to adhere to traditional sex roles.

Feminine culture: A culture in which people, regardless of sex, are expected to assume a variety of roles based on the circumstances and their own choices.

Page 123:

Ethnocentrism: The belief that one's own culture is superior to others.

Page 125:

Stereotypes: Attributions that cover up individual differences and ascribe certain characteristics to a group of people.

Prejudice: A rigid attitude based on group membership.

Page 128:

Altruism: A display of genuine and unselfish concern for the welfare of others.

Egocentricity: A selfish interest in one's own needs, to the exclusion of everything else.

Page 130:

Intercultural empathy: Imaginatively placing yourself in the dissimilar other person's cultural world to attempt to experience what he or she is experiencing.

Flexibility: the ability to adjust your communication to fit the other person and the situation.

Chapter 8:

Communicating skills in interpersonal relationships

(Book page 158-178)

Page 158:

Comforting: Helping people feel better about themselves, their behavior, or their situation by creating a safe conversational space where they can express their feelings and work out a plan for the future.

Buffering messages: Comforting messages that are phrased very politely in ways that address another person's face needs.

Positive face: Needs the desires to be appreciated and approved, liked, and honored.

Page 159:

Negative face: Needs the desires to be free from imposition and intrusion.

Other-centered messages: Comforting messages that encourage relational partners to talk about and elaborate on what happened and how they feel about it.

Page 160:

Reframing the situation: Offering ideas, observations, information, or alternative explanations that might help a relational partner understand a situation in a different light.

Giving advice: Presenting relevant suggestions and proposals that a person can use to resolve a situation.

Page 161:

Disclosure: Revealing confidential or secret information about others as well as yourself.

Privacy: The right of an individual to keep biographical data, personal ideas, and feelings secret.

Privacy management: Exercising personal control over confidential information in order to enhance autonomy or minimize vulnerability.

Page 167:

Describing feelings: The skill of naming the emotions you are feeling without judging them.

Page 169:

Describing behavior: Accurately recounting the specific behaviors of another without commenting on their appropriateness.

Page 170:

Praise: Describing the specific positive behaviors or accomplishments of another and the effect that behavior has on others.

Constructive criticism: Describing specific behaviors of another that hurt the person or that person's relationships with others.

Page 172:

Establishing a boundary: Effectively respond to people who expect you to disclose information you prefer to keep private.

Page 173:

Passive behavior: Not expressing personal preferences or defending our rights because we fear the cost and are insecure in the relationships, have very low self-esteem, or value the other person above our self.

Page 174:

Aggressive behavior: Belligerently or violently confronting another with your preferences, feelings, needs, or rights with little regard for the situation or for the feelings or rights of others.

Assertive behavior: Expressing your personal preferences and defending your personal rights while respecting the preferences and rights of others.

Page 175:

Interpersonal conflict: When the needs or ideas of one person are at odds with the needs or ideas of another.

Page 177:

Withdrawing: Managing conflict by physically or psychologically removing yourself.

Accommodating: Managing conflict by satisfying others' needs or accepting others' ideas while neglecting our own.

Forcing: Managing conflict by satisfying your own needs or advancing your own ideas, with no concern for the needs or ideas of the other and no concern for the harm done to the relationship.

Page 178:

Collaborating: Managing conflict by fully addressing the needs and issues of each party and arriving at a solution that is mutually satisfying.

That's the end folks.

Allah aap sab ko kamyab kare Aameen.